

O-Brain Complete Beginner Guide

O-Brain — Complete Beginner Guide

Even if **computers / AI / software** are brand new to you, just follow along. Hard words are explained in ().

0. What is O-Brain? (1-minute intro)

AI (Claude Code) is smart, but **the moment you close the chat it forgets everything** you just said — like a *brilliant friend with bad amnesia*.

O-Brain is the “auto-notepad” you keep next to that friend. - It automatically writes down important **decisions, promises, and rules** from your chats, - reminds the AI next time (the AI can even **trace relations & evolution** mid-chat), - and shows your memories as a **graph (map), an overview (at-a-glance summary), a list, and a timeline**. - It runs **100% on your own PC** (nothing leaves over the internet).

Terms: **Claude Code** = an AI tool you use in a terminal. **Plugin** = an add-on you install into Claude Code. **Local** = inside your own PC.

1. Quick Start (3-minute summary)

In a hurry? Just do this. Details from section 3 onward.

1. **Install Node.js** (only if missing) → the **LTS** version at nodejs.org → after installing, **open a new window**.
2. In the **Claude Code input box**, type these two lines one by one:

```
/plugin marketplace add D:\AI_Dev_Work\2026y\26y_06m_21d_O-Brain\plugin  
/plugin install o-brain@o-brain-local
```

3. **Restart Claude Code.** → Installation done.
4. Chat as usual, then say a clear **decision sentence**. e.g., `Let's set this project's port to 7740`
5. **End the chat** (type `/clear`). → Saved at this moment.
6. To see the screen, type `/o-brain:open` in Claude Code → your memory map opens in the browser.

2. Prerequisites · Required Programs · Downloads

What	Required?	Where / How
Windows PC	Required	This guide assumes Windows.
Node.js (LTS)	Required	nodejs.org → big green LTS button → download → keep clicking "Next". (It's the "engine" that runs programs.)
Claude Code	Required	The tool you already use.
Internet	Install only	Only for first install / first run (one-time download of a small AI model). After that, works offline.
Web browser	Required	Chrome, Edge, anything (to view the screen).
API key / payment	Not needed	O-Brain costs nothing — 100% free and local.

Downloading O-Brain itself: It's already in `D:\AI_Dev_Work\2026y\26y_06m_21d_O-Brain\`. Nothing extra to download.

3. Install (just 2 steps, follow exactly)

The two lines below go into the **Claude Code input box** (prompt) — **inside Claude Code**, not Windows Explorer.

① **Register the marketplace** — tells it where the plugin folder is.

```
/plugin marketplace add D:\AI_Dev_Work\2026y\26y_06m_21d_O-Brain\plugin
```

② **Install** — installs O-Brain from that list.

```
/plugin install o-brain@o-brain-local
```

③ **Restart Claude Code** → done.

- `o-brain` = plugin name, `o-brain-local` = marketplace (list) name.
- Doing `/plugin install <folder path>` in one step gives a “**Marketplace not found**” error. Always use the **2 steps**.
- If blocked with “not a git repo”, run `git init && git add -A && git commit -m init` in the `plugin` folder, then retry ①.

4. Check it installed

In the Claude Code input box: - `/o-brain:status` → shows memory count, recent memories, and status (in Korean). - `/o-brain:selftest` → one-shot brain check (save / secret-masking / search).    means OK.

5. How to Use & How It Works (the key part — very easy)

How it works, in one line: *When you end a chat, O-Brain scans it and auto-saves only the “decision / promise / rule” sentences.*

1. Chat as usual.

2. Say things you want remembered as **clear decision sentences**.

- Good: `Let's set this project's test port to 7740` / `Never commit API keys`
- Not captured: small talk, plain commands like `cd folder`. (Only clear "decide / use / forbid"-type lines.)

3. End the chat: type `/clear` (or close the window). → **Saved at this moment**.

4. Verify: `/o-brain:status` → memory count grows and your sentence appears.

Automatic security: passwords / API keys (sk-... etc.) are **masked before being stored** (`[REDACTED]`). This is not a "100% safe" guarantee — always stay careful.

6. Using the Dashboard

To open: type `/o-brain:open` in Claude Code (starts the server if it's off, then opens the browser). Address: `http://127.0.0.1:7740/` (bookmark it to reopen with one click).

Four views (top tabs — Graph is the start screen): - **Graph** — a map of dots and lines (toggle 2D / 3D). **This is the screen you land on.** - **Overview** — an at-a-glance summary: total count, last 7 days, **distribution by type/topic/project**, most-connected memories, most-viewed. Click "**connected-less memories**" to see only the orphans in the graph. - **List** — memories as cards: type badge, importance (★), date, view count. (As it grows, use "**Load more**" at the bottom.) - **Timeline** — chronological.

Quick search/navigation: press `⌘K` (Mac) / `Ctrl+K` (Windows) anywhere to open a small palette that finds *commands* (*switch views, theme, export*) and *memories* at once and jumps right there.

In the graph you can: - **Hover** a dot → connected memories highlight. - **Click** a dot → details open on the right. - **Search** — top box (press `/` to jump there). Matching dots brighten in the graph. - "**분류색**" (**category color**) **button** — recolor dots by *type* ↔ *topic* (security, UI, deploy, ...). - "**전체 보기**" (**show all**) / **focus** — the **◎ (target) button** in the detail panel shows *only that memory and its direct links*; "**전체 보기**" returns to the full map. - **Frequently-opened memories glow brighter** (view count). - **Zoom** — `+` / `-` / `fit` buttons at bottom-right. - **As memories grow**, the graph shows the *most important ones first* and tells you "**top M of N**" (so it stays fast).

Detail panel (right side, when a memory is clicked): - Content, type, category, importance, source, confidence, date, view count. - **Copy / Edit** ( **content · type · importance**) / **Delete** (irreversible, but a startup backup exists) /  **Focus**. - *Even on edit, secrets like passwords/keys are auto-redacted again when saved.* - **“This memory’s relations”** — link to other memories as **supersedes / supports / influences / contradicts** (mis-click → “undo” to restore).

Top tools: search · type/category chips · **importance, period & project filters** · sort (newest/oldest/importance) · **light/dark theme** · **export (JSON/Markdown)**.

7. Commands at a Glance

What	Where	Command
Install ① register	Claude Code	<code>/plugin marketplace add</code> <code>D:\AI_Dev_Work\2026y\26y_06m_21d_0-Brain\plugin</code>
Install ② install	Claude Code	<code>/plugin install o-brain@o-brain-local</code>
Status	Claude Code	<code>/o-brain:status</code>
Self-test	Claude Code	<code>/o-brain:selftest</code>
Backup	Claude Code	<code>/o-brain:backup</code>
Open dashboard (auto, recommended)	Claude Code	<code>/o-brain:open</code>
Screen (manual)	Terminal	<code>cd</code> <code>D:\AI_Dev_Work\2026y\26y_06m_21d_0-Brain\app</code> → <code>npm start</code>
Screen URL	Browser	<code>http://127.0.0.1:7740/</code>
Backup (manual)	Terminal	<code>cd ...\app</code> → <code>npm run backup</code>

8. Workflow (an example day)

- 1. **Start working** — when you open Claude Code, some past memories are auto-referenced by the AI (read-back).
- 2. **While working** — when a key decision is made, state it clearly (it becomes a save target).
- 3. **Finish** — end the session with `/clear` → that chat's decisions get saved.
- 4. **Sometimes** — open the screen with `/o-brain:open` to browse memories, link relations, or delete what you don't need.
- 5. **Periodically** — back up with `/o-brain:backup` (also auto-backs up when the server starts).

9. File · Data · Document Locations (absolute paths)

What	Location
Project folder	D:\AI_Dev_Work\2026y\26y_06m_21d_0-Brain\
Local app (code)	...\app\
Plugin	...\plugin\
Memory DB (precious)	...\app\data\obrain.db
Backup folder	...\app\data\backup\ (keeps latest 7)
Settings file	...\app\.env.local (sample: ...\.env.local.example)
User README	...\README.md (Korean) · ...\README.en.md (English)
This guide	...\GUIDE.ko.md · ...\GUIDE.en.md (+ each .pdf)
Design docs (for devs)	...\PRD\ (hidden folder, 13 docs)
Implementation brief	...\AGENTS.md

Key settings (.env.local): *(defaults are fine for most — only when changing, copy .env.Local.example to .env.Local)* - `OBRAIN_PORT` — the screen's port (default 7740). Change it on conflict. - `OBRAIN_DATA_DIR` — folder to store memories (default `app\data`). -

`OBRAIN_EXTRACT_MODE` — extraction mode (default `rule` = rule-based, free, local). `ai` (Haiku) mode is next — needs `ANTHROPIC_API_KEY` only when enabled. - `OBRAIN_VEC_GATE` — search sensitivity (default 0.92; lower = stricter).

10. Backup & Restore (protect your memories)

- **Backup:** `/o-brain:backup` (or `npm run backup`). Also auto-runs once when the server starts.
 - Location: `...\app\data\backup\` (keeps the latest 7 automatically)
 - **Restore:** if something breaks, copy the most recent `obrain-....db` from `backup\` over `app\data\obrain.db`. (Copy the current file elsewhere first.)
 - ⚠ Data lives only in that folder — **don't put it in a cloud-synced folder** (conflict/leak risk).
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11. Troubleshooting (things actually hit)

Symptom	Cause	Fix
Marketplace not found	Tried to install in one step	Use the 2 steps (register → install)
Nothing gets saved	No decision sentence / session not ended	Say a clear decision sentence, then <code>/clear</code>
Screen (URL) won't open	Server not running / port conflict	<code>/o-brain:open</code> again, or change <code>OBRAIN_PORT</code> in <code>.env.local</code>
'node' is not recognized	Node.js not installed	Install LTS from nodejs.org → new window
3D graph won't show	No WebGL / low-spec	Switch to 2D
Search wrong / empty	1 character or too vague	Use 2+ characters, clearer words
Install refused (not a git repo)	Local folder	In <code>plugin</code> folder: <code>git init</code> && <code>git add -A</code> && <code>git commit -m init</code>
Moved to a new PC, doesn't work	Paths are tuned to this PC	Keep the same path, or ask the developer to adjust (currently single-user / this-PC)

If stuck, share the **exact screen (or error message)** — we'll fix it together.

12. Safety · Privacy

- Runs **entirely on your PC**. Memories never leave over the internet.
- The screen server binds only to **127.0.0.1 (your PC)** — not reachable from other devices.
- Secrets (passwords/keys) are **auto-masked** before saving (not a perfect guarantee).
- Keeping and backing up data is **your responsibility**.

13. License · Copyright · Commercial Use (⚠ Strict — please read)

- **Current license: Apache License 2.0 © 2026 SoDam AI Studio** (full text in the `LICENSE` file at the project root).
 - **Personal / local use:** using it on your own PC for personal purposes is fine.
 - **Redistribution / modification / commercial use:** permitted under Apache-2.0 terms (keep copyright & license notices, state changes, etc.). *That said, this repository is currently kept **private**, and whether to make it public is the author's decision.*
 - **No warranty (AS-IS):** provided "as is". **All responsibility for outcomes, data loss, or malfunction lies with the user;** the author makes no warranty whatsoever.
 - **Third-party terms are separate:** if you later enable AI features (e.g., Anthropic Claude), **that provider's terms, fees, and policies apply separately** and are unrelated to O-Brain's license.
 - **Trademarks / names:** "Claude", "Anthropic", etc. are trademarks of their owners; O-Brain is not affiliated with or endorsed by them.
 - **Bundled libraries:** O-Brain uses open-source components (e.g., better-sqlite3, sqlite-vec, force-graph, @huggingface/transformers); **each library's own license applies.** Include their license notices when distributing.
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14. Honest Limitations (current v0.1)

- It remembers **clear decision sentences** well; vague phrasing may be missed.
 - **Topic classification is automatic but sometimes wrong** (rule-based). **Linking memories (relations) is still manual.**
 - Smarter **AI auto-extraction** is not built yet (enabling it would require a separate API key / cost — currently not applied).
 - It is a **single-user / this-PC** stage (moving/sharing to another PC needs extra work).
 - This is not a finished, warranted product — it's being refined through real use.
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Written from verified, working values (v0.1, as of 2026-06-21). If something breaks, share the exact screen and we'll fix it together.